

Variables in the Main Merged Dataset

main_data_county_year.dta

309 vars, 151,145 obs

ID / panel variables

Variable	Type	Label
geoid	str5	
fips_num	long	Numeric county FIPS (real(geoid)); geoid remains the canonical string merge key
state_fips	str2	
county_fips	str3	
county_name	str24	
year	int	
n_incomplete_months	byte	

PRISM weather (repeats 12x: suffix _m1 ... _m12)

Variable pattern	Type	Base variable
cooling_degree_days_m#	float	cooling_degree_days
days_below_freezing_32f_m#	byte	days_below_freezing_32f
days_extremely_cold_m#	byte	days_extremely_cold
days_precip_above_10mm_m#	byte	days_precip_above_10mm
freeze_thaw_days_m#	byte	freeze_thaw_days
heating_degree_days_m#	float	heating_degree_days
mean_temp_c_m#	float	mean_temp_c
n_days_m#	byte	n_days
tmax_variance_c2_m#	float	tmax_variance_c2
tmean_variance_c2_m#	float	tmean_variance_c2
tmin_variance_c2_m#	float	tmin_variance_c2

11 base vars x up to 12 months = 132 columns

ERA5 snow (repeats 12x: suffix _m1 ... _m12)

Variable pattern	Type	Base variable
days_snow_depth_12in_m#	byte	days_snow_depth_12in
days_snow_depth_18in_m#	byte	days_snow_depth_18in
days_snow_depth_8in_m#	byte	days_snow_depth_8in
mean_snow_depth_m#	float	mean_snow_depth
total_snowfall_mm_m#	float	total_snowfall_mm

5 base vars x up to 12 months = 60 columns

Population (Census)

Variable	Type	Label
pop_share_0_4 ...	double	Share of population in each 5-yr age band (18 vars)
pop_share_85plus		
population	long	Total resident population, all ages, all sexes
population_source	str28	Census product this county-year's total came from
age_source	str28	Census product this county-year's age detail came from
population_flag	str108	Non-empty if total population is missing//approximate
age_flag	str43	Non-empty if age shares are missing/unusable

Vehicle collisions (from collisions_CONUS_county_year_1985_2020.dta)

Variable(s)	Type	Notes
state_letter_code	str2	Abbreviation of State Name
state_name	str14	Name of State
fips	long	Combination of State & County FIPS
flag_data_issue	byte	
total_fatal, total_fatalities, total_injuries, total_injury, total_pdo, total_total	num	Crash counts, all vehicle types (6 vars)
animal_fatal, animal_fatalities, animal_injuries, animal_injury, animal_pdo, animal_total, animal_total_injury	num	Crash counts, animal-involved (7 vars)
deer_fatal, deer_fatalities, deer_injuries, deer_injury, deer_pdo, deer_total	num	Crash counts, deer-involved (6 vars)
wild_animal_fatal, wild_animal_fatalities, wild_animal_injuries, wild_animal_injury, wild_animal_pdo, wild_animal_total	num	Crash counts, wild-animal-involved (6 vars)
imputation_flag_animal_pdo, imputation_flag_animal_total, imputation_flag_deer_pdo, imputation_flag_deer_total, imputation_flag_pdo, imputation_flag_total_pdo, imputation_flag_total_total, imputation_flag_wild_animal_total	byte	Imputation flags (8 vars)
any_animal_fatal, any_animal_fatalities, any_animal_injuries, any_animal_injury, any_animal_pdo, any_animal_total	int	=1 if any animal-crash outcome present (6 vars)
animal_fatalities_to_crashes, animal_pdo_to_crashes, deer_fatalities_to_crashes, deer_pdo_to_crashes, deer_pdo_to_fatal, fatalities_to_pdo, total_fatalities_to_crashes, total_pdo_to_crashes, total_fatal_to_deerfatal	float	Ratio/rate variables (9 vars)

Wildlife harvest (Nicole's panel)

Variable	Type	Label
state	str2	State postal abbreviation
harvest_total	int	Total deer harvested, all categories combined
source_harvest	str6	Compilation: agency-direct harmonization or Schuler et al. CWD panel
flag_total_constructed	byte	=1 if total was constructed from components rather than source-reported
flag_hand_transcribed	byte	=1 if figure was hand-transcribed from an image-scanned report (WV only)
harvest_total_cwd_imputed	int	CWD imputed harvest value, parked and NOT used in harvest_total
in_window	byte	=1 if year in 2005-2014 and harvest observed
main_sample	byte	=1 if county balanced across all of 2005-2014 (both sources)
main_sample_agency	byte	=1 if balanced 2005-2014 AND agency-direct (robustness sample)

Winter severity variables

Variable	Type	Label
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mean_winter_temp	double	Mean of Dec(t-1)/Jan(t)/Feb(t) PRISM monthly mean temp, degrees C
warm_winter_1sd	byte	1 if mean_winter_temp > county's own full-sample mean + 1 SD
warm_winter_2sd	byte	1 if mean_winter_temp > county's own full-sample mean + 2 SD
winter_severity_index	int	Winter Severity Index (Kohn 1975 / WI DNR): wsi_cold_days + wsi_snow_days. Cat
winter_severity_index_sn owl2	int	SENSITIVITY WSI: wsi_cold_days + wsi_snow_days_12in (>=12in snow instead of Kohn
winter_severity_index_sn ow8	int	SENSITIVITY WSI: wsi_cold_days + wsi_snow_days_8in (>=8in snow instead of Kohn
wsi_cold_days	byte	WSI cold-stress component: # days Dec 1-Apr 30 with PRISM min temp <=0F
wsi_snow_days	int	WSI snow-hazard component: # days Dec 1-Apr 30 with ERA5 county-mean snow dept
wsi_snow_days_12in	int	SENSITIVITY (not Kohn): # days Dec 1-Apr 30 with ERA5 county-mean snow depth >
wsi_snow_days_8in	int	SENSITIVITY (not Kohn): # days Dec 1-Apr 30 with ERA5 county-mean snow depth >

Merge-status flags

Variable	Type	Label
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merge_collisions	byte	
merge_era5_snow	byte	
merge_population	byte	
merge_wildlife	byte	

Unclassified variables (script needs updating)

Variable	Type	Label
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ppt_total_m1	float	1 ppt_total
ppt_total_m10	float	10 ppt_total
ppt_total_m11	float	11 ppt_total
ppt_total_m12	float	12 ppt_total
ppt_total_m2	float	2 ppt_total
ppt_total_m3	float	3 ppt_total
ppt_total_m4	float	4 ppt_total
ppt_total_m5	float	5 ppt_total
ppt_total_m6	float	6 ppt_total
ppt_total_m7	float	7 ppt_total
ppt_total_m8	float	8 ppt_total
ppt_total_m9	float	9 ppt_total